



PRIME'S CIMETIDINE 200 TABLET

Description: White, round, biconvex tablet.

Content

Each tablet contains cimetidine 200mg.

Indications

It is indicated in the treatment of active peptic ulcer, NSAID induced lesions, gastroesophageal reflux disease and Zollinger-Ellison syndrome.

Pharmacology

Cimetidine is a histamine H₂ - receptor antagonist. Accordingly, it inhibits gastric acid secretion and reduces pepsin output. It has also been shown to inhibit other actions of histamine mediated by H₂ receptors. It has a weak anti androgenic effect such as gynaecomastia have occasionally occurred. Cimetidine is readily absorbed from the gastrointestinal tract after administration with food delaying the rate of absorption. Cimetidine is partially metabolised in liver to sulfoxide and to hydroxymethylcimetidine. Most of the cimetidine is excreted unchanged. Cimetidine crosses the placental barrier and is excreted into breast milk.

Adverse effects

Adverse reactions to cimetidine are generally infrequent and are usually reversible following a reduction of dosage or withdrawal of therapy. The commonest side effect reported have been diarrhoea, dizziness, tiredness, headache and rashes. Reversible confusional states, esp. in the elderly or in seriously ill patients such as those with renal failure, have occasionally occurred. Cimetidine has a weak anti androgenic effect and gynaecomastia and impotence have also occasionally occurred in men receiving relatively high doses for conditions such as Zollinger-Ellison syndrome. Other adverse effects which have been reported rarely are hypersensitivity reaction and fever, arthralgia, myalgia, blood disorders including agranulocytosis or neutropenia and thrombocytopenia, interstitial nephritis, hepatotoxicity and cardiovascular disorders.

Precautions

Before giving cimetidine to patients with gastric ulcers, the possibility of malignancy should be excluded since cimetidine may mask symptoms and delay diagnosis. It should be given in reduced dosage to patients with impaired renal function and hepatic impairment. It should also be used with caution on pregnant and lactating mothers.

Drug Interactions

Cimetidine has been reported to have interactions with many drugs. Reduction in dosage of some drugs, such as cyclosporin, lignocaine, nifedipine, p-aminocaine, suxamethonium, theophylline and warfarin may be needed. The majority of interactions are due to binding of cimetidine to cytochrome P450 in the liver with subsequent inhibition of microsomal oxidative metabolism and increased plasma concentration of drugs metabolised by these enzymes. Other mechanisms of interaction such as altered absorption, competition for renal tubular excretion and changes in hepatic blood flow play only a minor role.

Contraindications

It is contraindicated in hypersensitive patients.

Dosage and administration (ORAL)

Duodenal ulcer : 800mg daily at bedtime for at least 4 weeks. Maintenance dose of 400mg at bedtime, or both in the morning and at bedtime.

Gastric ulcer : 800mg daily at bedtime for at least 6 weeks. Maintenance dose of 400mg at bedtime, or both in the morning and at bedtime.

Oesophageal reflux : 400mg four times daily (with meals and at bedtime) for 4 - 8 weeks.

Zollinger-Ellison syndrome : 400mg four times daily may also be required, occasionally increase to a total of 2.4gm daily.

Stress related ulceration of the upper gastrointestinal tract : 200mg or 400mg every 4 - 6 hours.

Risk of developing acid aspiration syndrome during general anaesthesia : 400mg 90 - 120 min before induction of anaesthesia or at the start of labour, and doses of up to 400mg may be repeated at intervals of 4 hours if required.

Symptoms and Treatment of Overdose

No significant effects for doses up to 20g. Treatment: Induction of vomiting and/or gastric lavage with symptomatic and supportive therapy.

Storage	: Keep container tightly closed. Store in a cool, dry place, below 30°C. Protect from light.
Presentation	: 100 x 10's : 1000's (EXPORT)
Shelf-life	: 3 years
Manufactured &	: PRIME PHARMACEUTICAL SDN. BHD.
Distributed by	: 1505, Lrg Per. Utama 1, Trn Perindustrian Bukit Tengah, 14000 Bukit Mertajam, P.Pinang, Malaysia.

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